Appendix 3: Gulf of Alaska salmon analysis

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Here we show the LM, GAM, and DLM analysis for the Gulf of Alaska salmon dataset. For complete code, see the full quarto document

Data Processing

First, we standardize and examine the trends in SST and salmon abundace from Litzow et al. 2018 updated with data through 2025 (Figure S3.1 & Figure S3.2).

LM

We start our investigation using linear models, to evaluate the relationship between salmon catch and SST anomalies with periods defined *a-priori* as before and after 1988/1989 (from Litzow et al. 2018). Previous investigations used this approach, and while we primarily discuss DLMs and GAMs for this dataset in the main text, we include this illustrative example here for completeness and comparability to the previous study.

We compare linear model structures using classic model selection criteria, AIC. First, we examine a 1) intercept only model, 2) salmon abundance with period as a predictor, 3) salmon abundance with period and SST anomalies as predictors, and 4) an interaction between SST anomalies and period. This shows that model 2 is a better fit to the data than model 1 indicating that a time-dependent intercept is an improvement to model fit than a time-independent intercept. Similarly, model 4 is the best model showing that a time-dependent slope with SST is an improvement to a time-independent slope (Table S3.1).

Functionally, model 4 has a time-dependent slope and a time-dependent intercept which we can see by both plotting the relationships and examining the model output. We can see a strong positive correlation prior to 1988 (Figure S3.3) followed by a weak negative relationship which is represented in the slopes of the relationship (Table S3.2 & Figure S3.4).

GAM

Next, we consider generalized additive models. We fit two distinct GAM models to the salmon catch data and SST anomalies to illustrate the differences in a model with a time-dependent slope and a time-dependent intercept. We find that when fitting a time-dependent slope and time-dependent intercept model, most of the variability in the relationship is explained by the time-dependent intercept (Figure S3.5) while the time-dependent slope does not change much through time (Figure S3.6). When only a time-dependent slope is fit to the data, the slope parameter is much more variable through time (Figure S3.6), and looks similar to the slope estimated by the linear models (Figure S3.4).

Next, we check the residuals plots for both parameterizations of the models. The time-dependent slope model appears to have some residual temporally variability while there are no trends through time in the model with both a time-dependent slope and a time-dependent intercept (Figure S3.7) and the qq-pot looks reasonable for both (Figure S3.8).

We need to decide if there is enough ecological evidence to support a model with both a time-dependent slope and time-dependent intercept and whether that model has signs of overfitting. We can do this by using cross validation and comparing the root mean square error (RMSE) of a set of training data compared to test data. For time series data its important that cross validation methods retain the temporal structure of the data. To do this, we used approximate leave-future out cross validation (LFO-CV) where we fit the model to 15 years of data (training data, first year to year n-1) and predict 1 year ahead (test data, year n). The model is used to produce in-sample predictions for the training data and one-year-ahead out of sample predictions for the test data. Then the model is iteratively refit walking one year ahead such that the training data then includes n and the test data is n+1. RMSE is then calculated for both the training and the test datasets based on predictions for each iteration. If RMSE of the training data is significantly lower than RMSE of the test data, it indicates the model is likely overfitting.

We compared LFO-CV for the training and test data for both candidate models: time-dependent slope and intercept, and time-dependent slope only (Figure S3.9). For the time-dependent slope and intercept model, the RMSE of the training data was significantly lower ($p < 0.05$) than the RMSE of the test data (Table S3.3). The RMSE of the training data was lower than the RMSE for the test data for the time-dependent slope model, but they were not significantly different ($p > 0.05$). Collectively with the residual diagnostics, we conclude that the time-dependent slope model is appropriate for interpreting ecological dynamics and performs better than the model that also included a time-dependent intercept (based on evidence of overfitting with this model parameterization). However, if the goal of fitting this model was prediction, it would be valuable to address the residual temporal variability that is not explained by SST and the time-dependent slope. Additional predictors and considering additional extrinsic factors that may contribute to the time-dependent salmon catch - SST relationship would be the next step.

DLM

We fit two distinct DLM models to the salmon catch data and SST anomalies to compare to the results of the GAM models. Generally, the parameters estimated by the DLM are more certain and follow similar patterns through time as the GAM (Figure S3.10 & Figure S3.11). There is also more interannual variability in the parameter estimates of the DLM compared to the continuously smoothed pattern of the GAM. We also find similar residual patterns for the DLM compared to the GAM (Figure S3.12 & Figure S3.13).

Figures and Tables

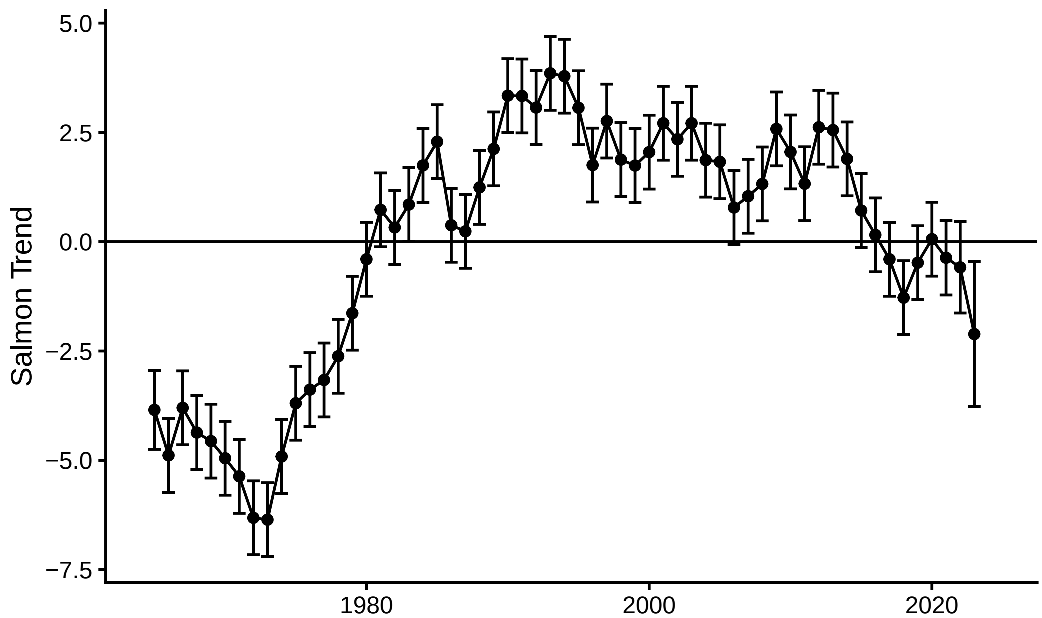

Figure S3.1: Time series of salmon catch from Lizow et al. 2018

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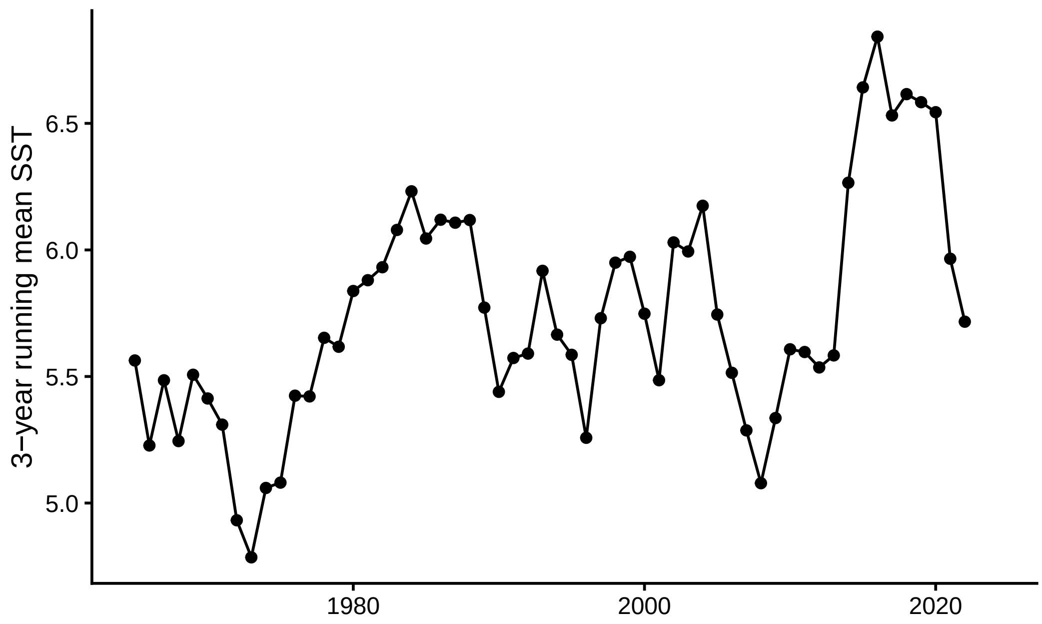

Figure S3.2: Time series of sea surface temperature anomalies from Lizow et al. 2018

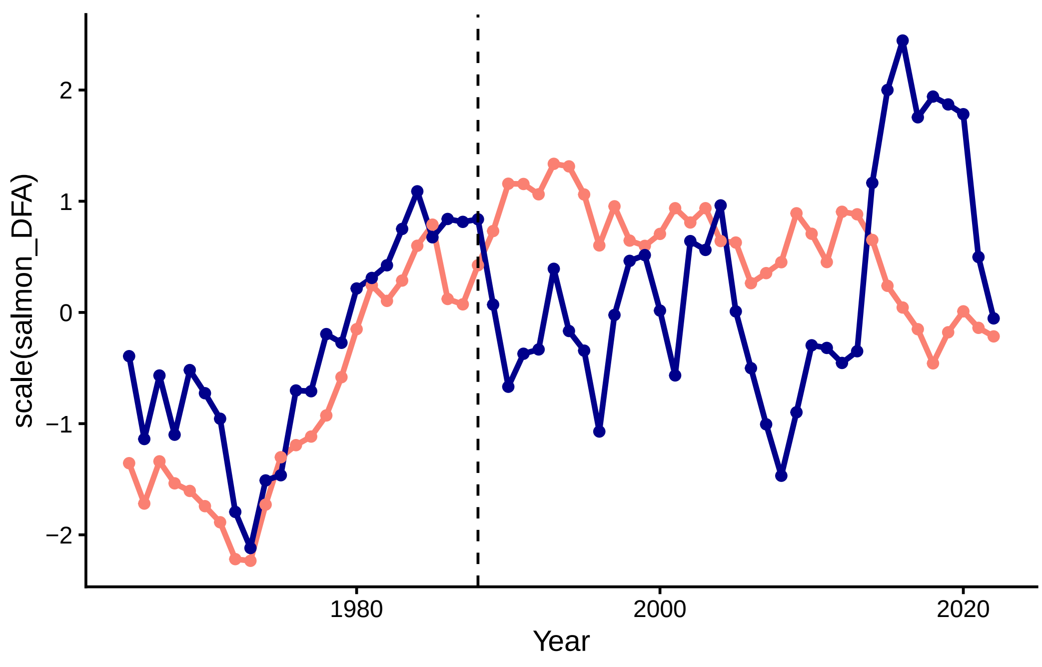

Figure S3.3: Time series of scaled salmon catch trend (salmon color) and SST anomalies (dark blue)

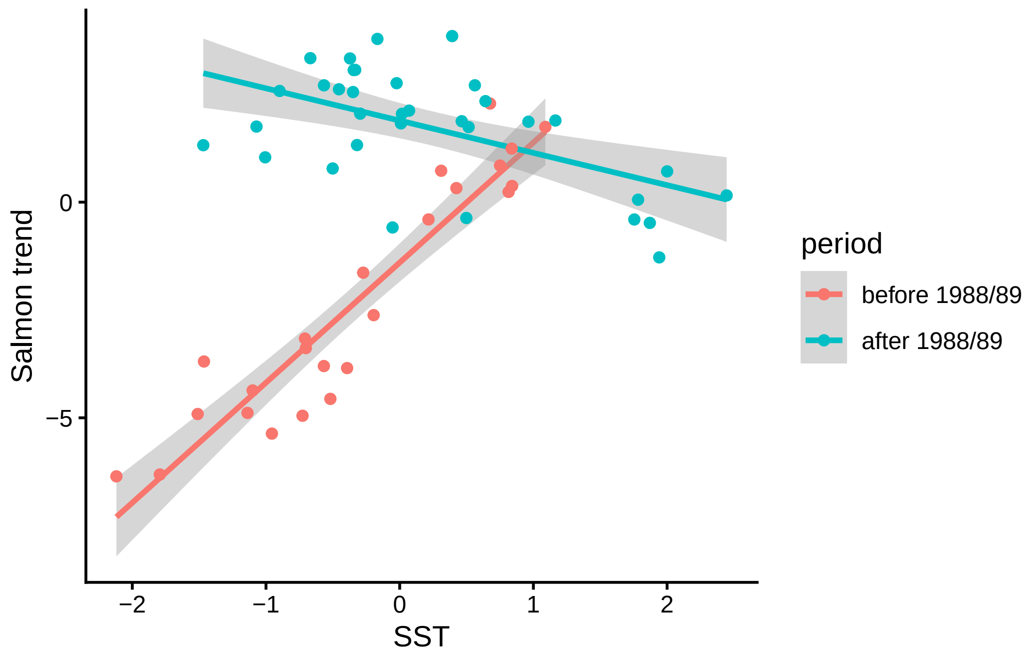

Figure S3.4: The relationship between salmon catch and SST anomalies before and after the 1988/1989 time periods

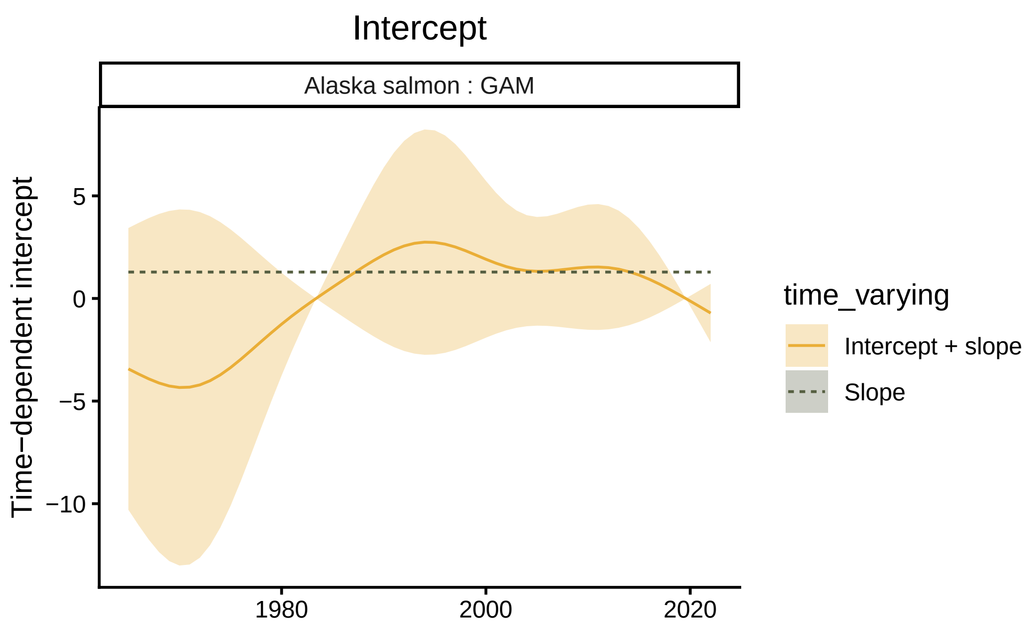

Figure S3.5: Time-dependent intercept of the GAM model representing the relationship between SST anomalies and salmon catch.

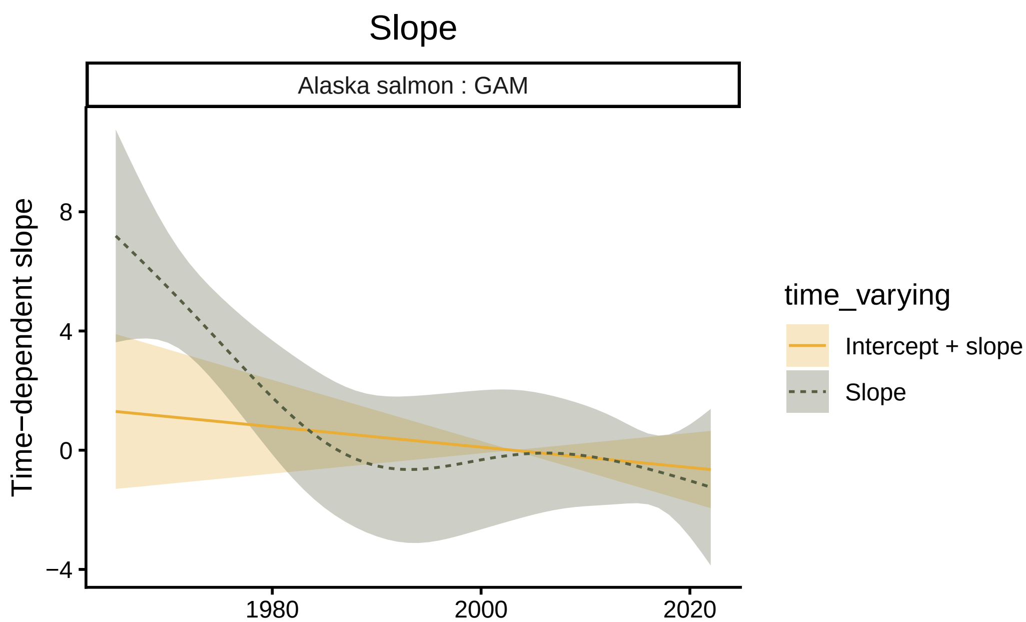

Figure S3.6: Time-dependent slope of the GAM model representing the relationship between SST anomalies and salmon catch.

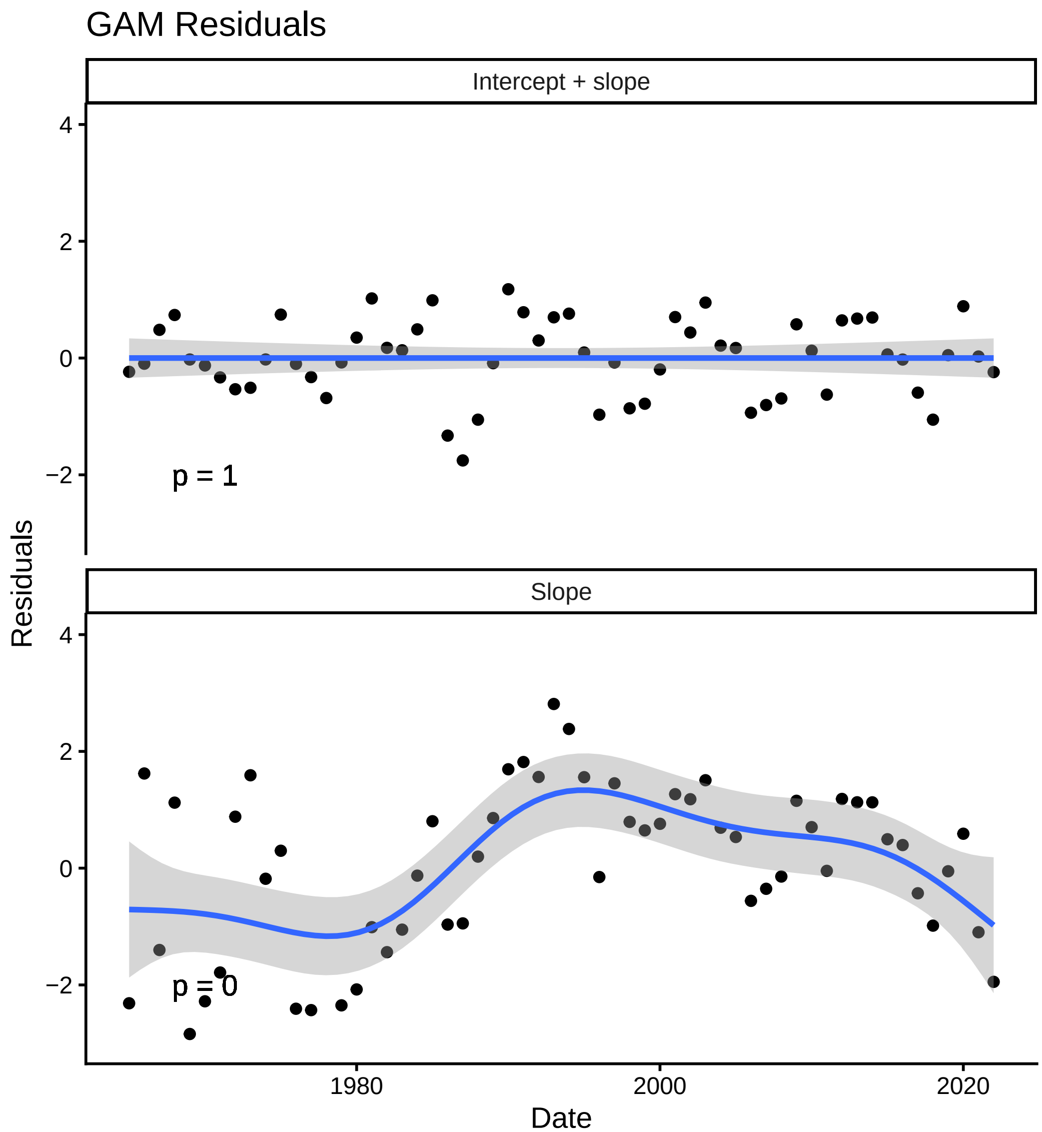

Figure S3.7: Time series of residuals from the GAM model fit with a time-dependent slope and both a time-dependent slope and intercept. p-value denotes the significance of the trend in residuals through time.

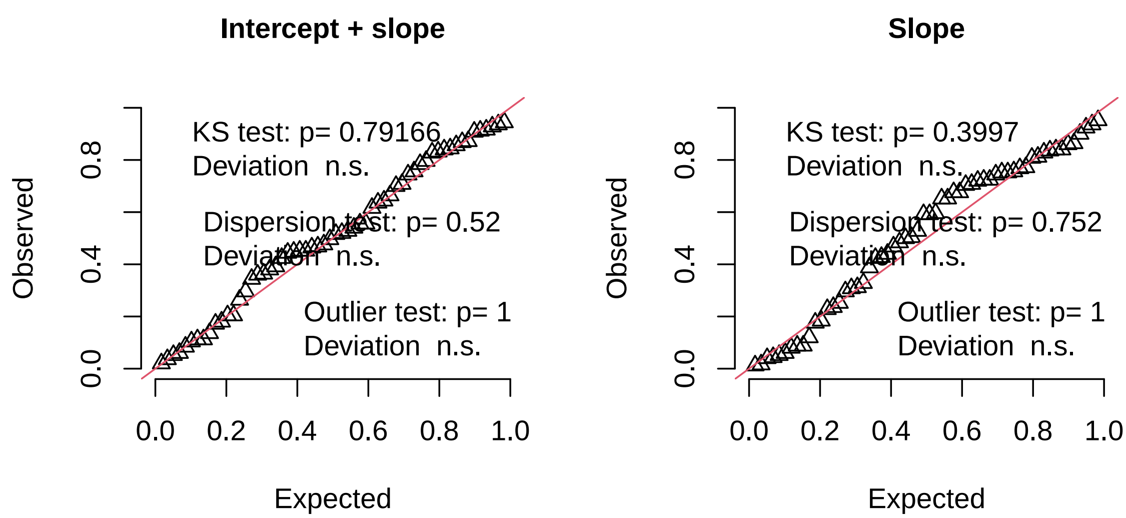

Figure S3.8: QQ plot from the GAM model fit with a time-dependent slope and both a time-dependent slope and intercept.

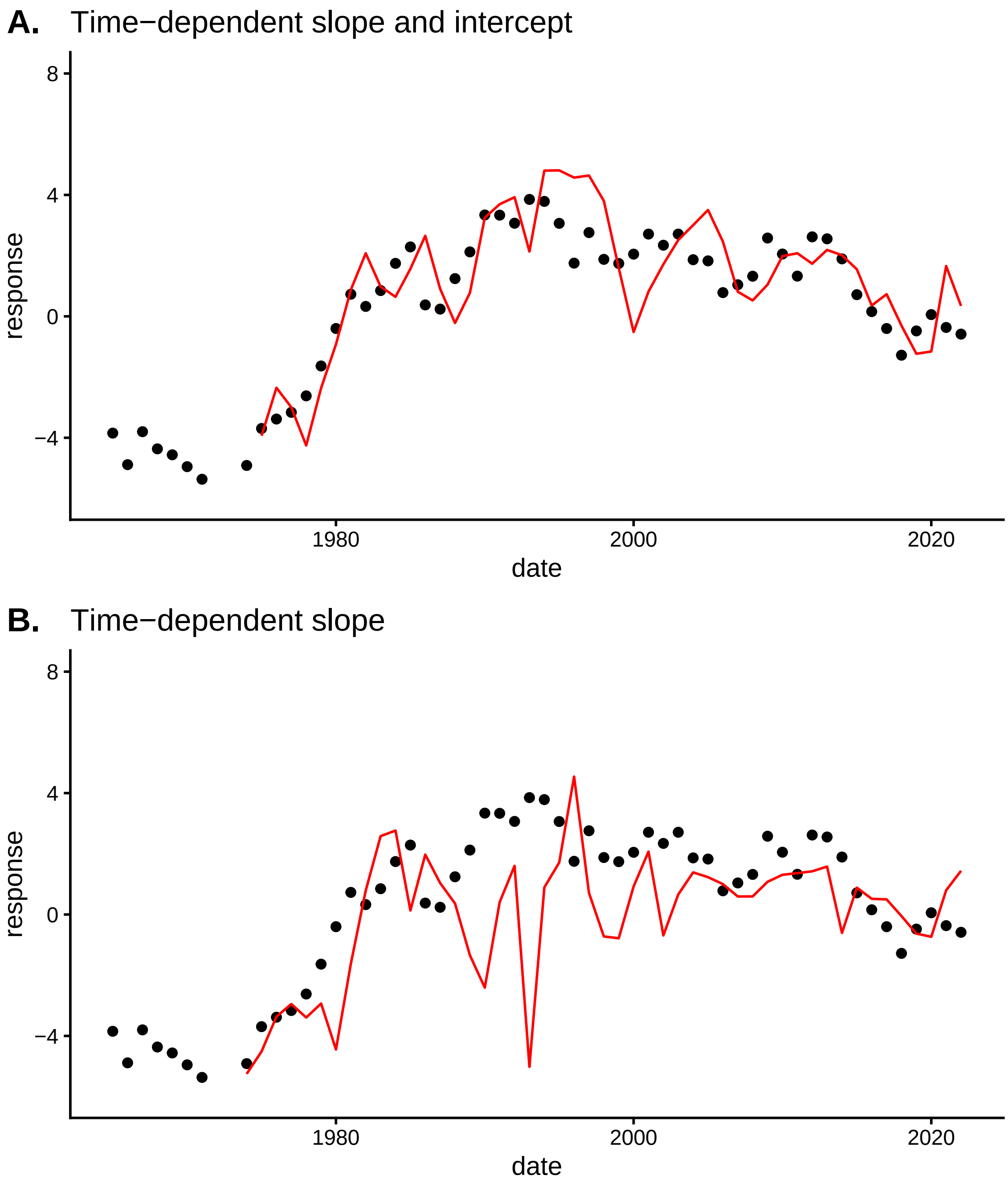

Figure S3.9: Leave-future-out cross validation for the GAM models fit with (A.) both a time-dependent slope and intercept, (B.) a time-dependent slope and and (C.).

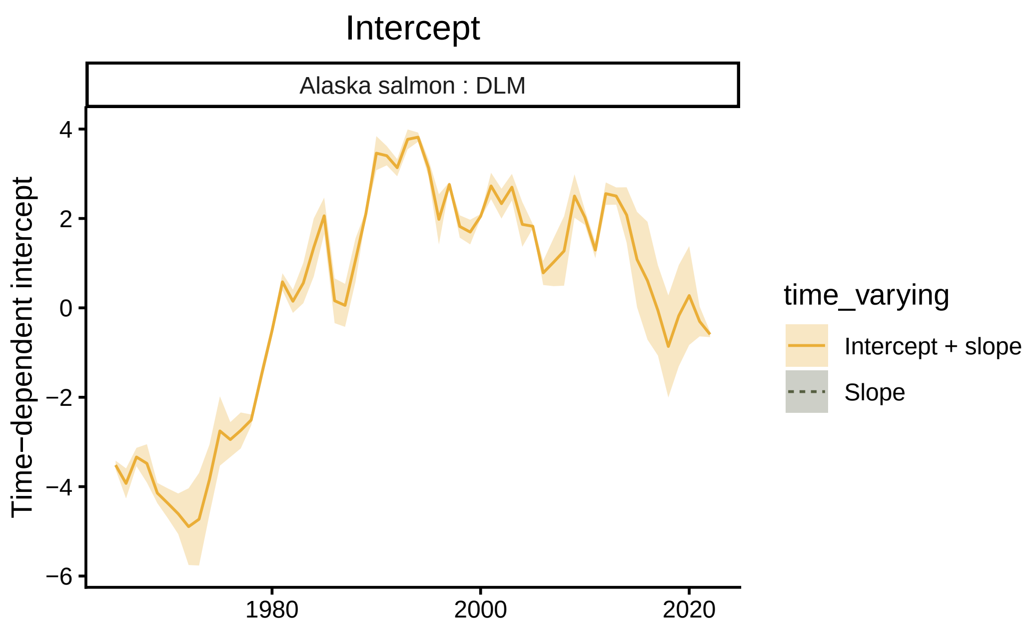

Figure S3.10: Time-dependent intercept of the DLM model representing the relationship between SST anomalies and salmon catch.

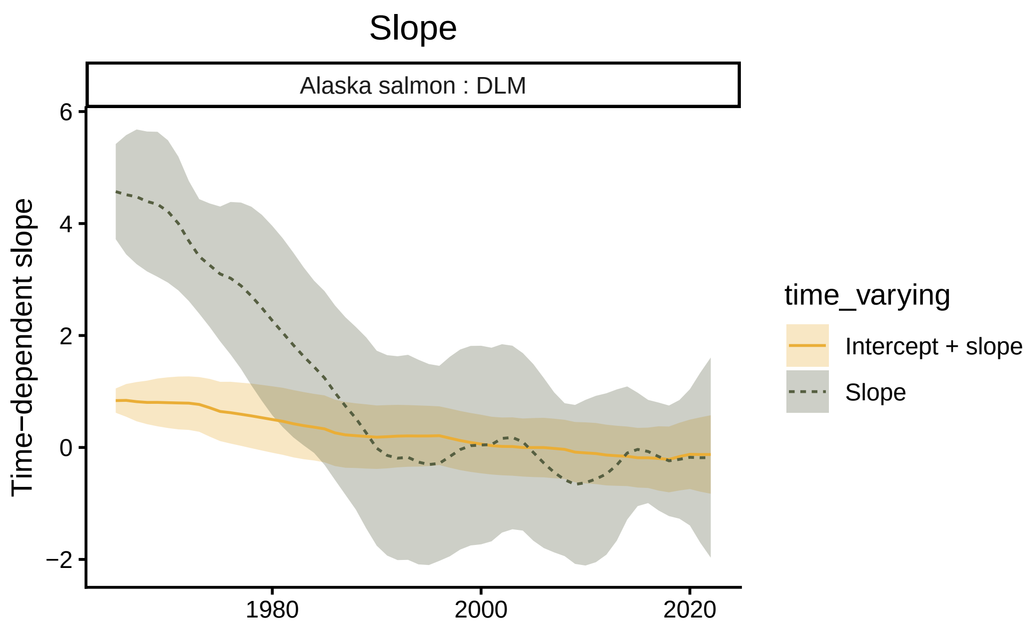

Figure S3.11: Time-dependent slope of the DLM model representing the relationship between SST anomalies and salmon catch.

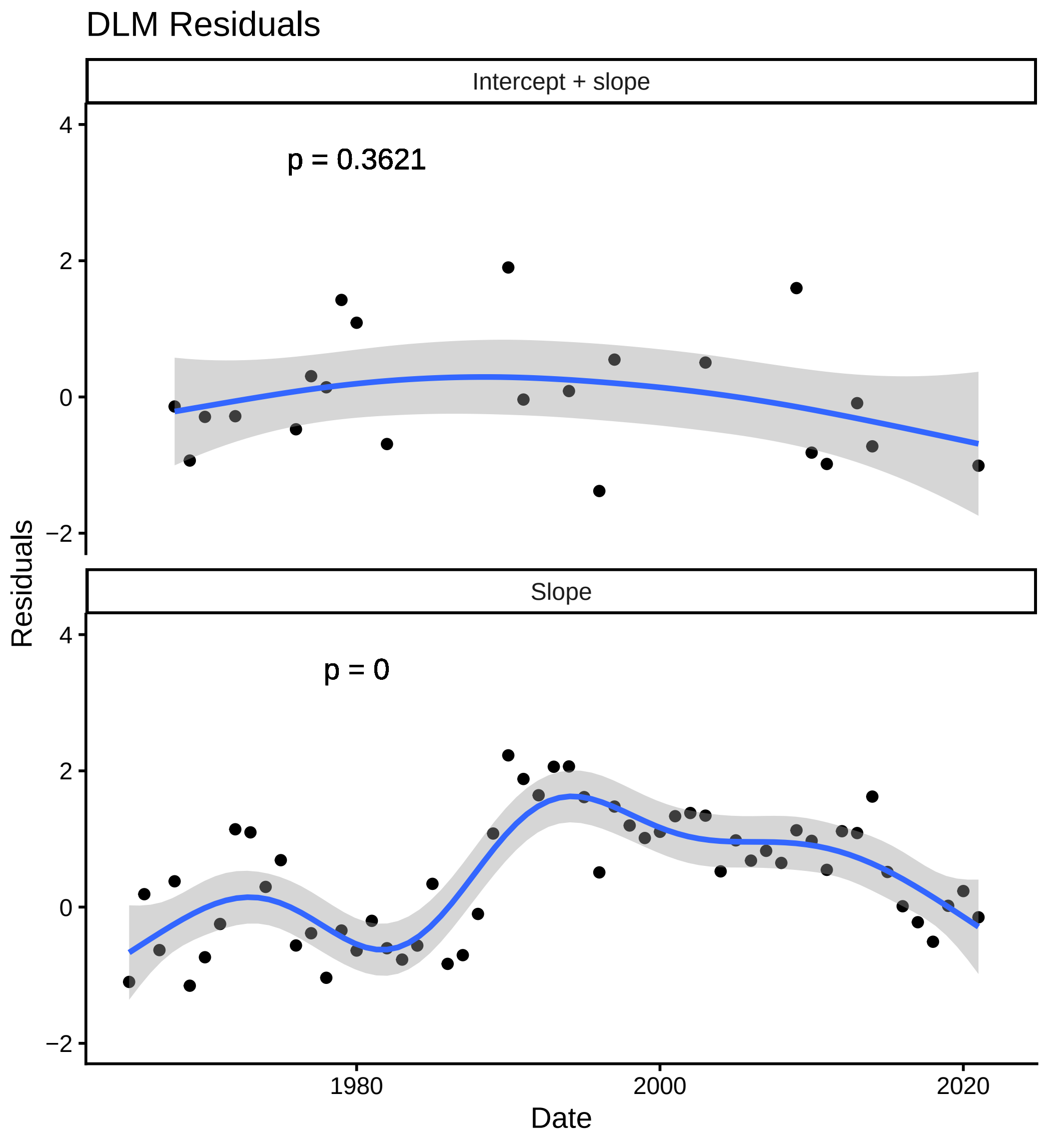

Figure S3.12: Time series of residuals from the DLM model fit with a time-dependent slope and both a time-dependent slope and intercept. p-value denotes the significance of the trend in residuals through time.

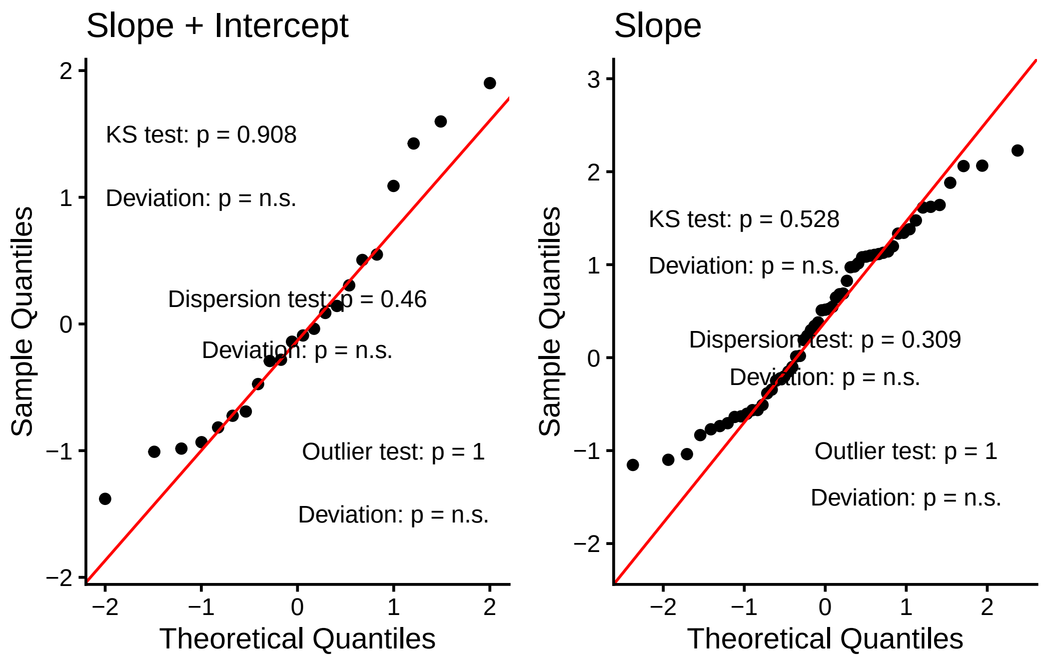

Figure S3.13: QQ plot from the DLM model fit with a time-dependent slope and both a time-dependent slope and intercept.

Model	AIC
1. Intercept only	289.46
2. Intercept by period only	
(time-dependent intercept)	251.43
3. Intercept by period and SST	248.80
4. Interaction between SST and period	
(time-dependent slope and intercept)	179.02
5. Time-dependent slope	247.52

Table S3.1: AIC values for five linear models

term	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(>|t|)
(Intercept)	-1.40	0.23	-5.96	0
z__sst	2.78	0.24	11.49	0
as.factor(period)late	3.29	0.30	10.89	0
z__sst:as.factor(period)late	-3.53	0.31	-11.50	0

Table S3.2: Summary of the output of the best supported model (model 4)

	leave-future-out train	leave-future-out test
Time-dependent slope & intercept	0.42	1.03
Time-dependent slope	1.19	1.60

Table S3.3: RMSE for LFO-CV for both test and training datasets for the time-dependent slope and intercept, and the time-dependent slope models.